GLOBAL TLM · GLOBAL TRUCKING LEAD MACHINE

The Trucking Agency Follow-Up Playbook

Templates for the first text, the first email and a 7-day follow-up sequence — for independent trucking insurance agencies that lose quote requests to slow or missing follow-up.

Global TLM · globaltlm.com · October 2026

Start here

A quote request is worth the most in the first few minutes after it lands. This playbook gives you what to send in those minutes and the week after: the first text, the first email, a missed-call text-back, and a 7-day sequence for the two ways a trucking lead goes quiet — never answered, or quoted and silent.

It is written for owners and managers of independent trucking insurance agencies: commercial auto for owner-operators and small fleets, quote requests coming from your website, Meta ads, lead vendors or referrals. Everything in it can be done by hand with a phone and an inbox. Copy the templates, replace the brackets ([Agency Name], [Agent Name], [Your Number]), and start with the next lead that comes in.

Two rules run through the whole thing. First, speed: the first touch goes out within five minutes, by text, because the person asking is probably in a truck. Second, consistency: the sequence only works if every lead gets every touch on the day it is due. Doing that for one lead is easy. Doing it for forty a month, while you also quote and service, is the hard part — which is why most agencies stop at touch two. The checklist at the end is built to keep you honest.

Why the first hour decides the quote

The best-known study on lead response is the Harvard Business Review audit of 2,241 US companies, which sent each a web inquiry and timed the reply: 37% answered within an hour, 16% within a day, 24% took more than a day, and 23% never answered at all. The average reply, among those who replied, came 42 hours later. In the same work, across 1.25 million leads at 42 companies, firms that tried to reach a lead within an hour were about seven times as likely to qualify it as firms that waited even an hour longer, and more than sixty times as likely as firms that waited a day. [1]

Two things to keep straight. That study measured "within an hour," not five minutes. The popular "100× better in five minutes" and "391% in the first minute" figures come from vendor data sets with no published baseline, so this playbook does not lean on them. [2][3] The honest reading is simpler: most agencies answer in hours or never, and answering in minutes puts you ahead of nearly everyone the trucker also asked.

On persistence, the only insurance-specific numbers come from a lead-management vendor's analysis of its own clients: a second call attempt raised the chance of reaching a lead by 87%, and 93% of leads that were ever reached had been reached by the sixth attempt. Treat those as a vendor's observation, not a law — but the direction matches what every agency sees. One attempt is not follow-up. [4]

On channel, the same vendor found that a text sent after a phone contact lifted conversion, while a text sent before any contact lowered the chance of ever reaching the lead. [5] A 2024 survey of 1,074 US mobile users found 57% expect a business to respond within 15 minutes. [6] For truckers specifically there is no clean study; the practical case for text-first is in the next section.

How truckers shop for insurance

They are shopping several agencies at once. No survey counts the quotes an owner-operator collects, so this playbook won't put a number on it. The pattern is visible anyway: the same quote request goes to every agency on the first page, the lead vendor's form, and a friend's agent. The agency that replies first and asks the right questions gets the conversation; the rest get silence. [7]

New authority is a different buyer. A carrier cannot get operating authority until the insurer files proof of the federal minimum — $750,000 liability for most for-hire property carriers, more for hazmat — so a new DOT/MC applicant is on a deadline and usually learning the process as they go. [8] Fewer markets write new ventures than established ones, and new-venture premiums are high in the first year or two before rates come down with clean experience. [9][10] That buyer needs a fast answer and a plain explanation of what documents you need; price shopping is secondary to getting on the road.

Established operators move at renewal. Practitioners now start renewal quoting 90 to 150 days before expiration and treat anything inside 30 days as a late, risky renewal. [11][12] An established trucker who asks for a quote in October is usually looking at a December or January renewal. Ask for the renewal date in the first email, and the rest of the year's follow-up calendar writes itself.

They are in the truck. Federal rules ban texting while driving and hand-held calling, and a driver can be behind the wheel for up to 11 hours inside a 14-hour window. [13][14][15] A call at 10 a.m. is a call into a cab. A text waits at the fuel island; a voicemail with a callback number gets heard at the end of the shift. That is why the first touch here is a short text, the call comes second, and every voicemail says the number out loud.

The first text (within 5 minutes)

Send it the moment the quote request lands, from the number your agency will keep texting from. Lead with the agency name so the trucker knows who it is, ask one question that moves the quote forward, and include the opt-out line on this first message. Each version is under 160 characters with the brackets filled by typical names; if your agency name is long, trim the middle, not the opt-out.

Version 1 — truck count (works for any lead)

```
[Agency Name]: Hi [First Name], [Agent Name] here. Got your truck insurance quote request. Quick one: how many trucks are you insuring? Reply STOP to opt out.
```

Version 2 — authority status (sorts new ventures from established)

```
[Agency Name]: Thanks for the quote request, [First Name]. I'm [Agent Name], a licensed agent. Is your authority new or established? Reply STOP to opt out.
```

Version 3 — new-authority leads (ads or forms aimed at new DOT/MC)

```
[Agency Name]: Hi [First Name], [Agent Name] here. I can get your quote moving today. Do you have your DOT/MC number yet? Reply STOP to opt out.
```

What not to do in the first text: no rates, no "cheapest," no coverage promises, no links. The job of this message is a reply, and a question gets replies. Save the booking link for the moment they answer.

Missed-call text-back

A trucker who calls and gets voicemail usually calls the next agency on the list. This message goes out automatically (or by hand, within a minute) to every missed call from a number you don't recognize. It tells them who you are, asks the one thing you need to know, and gives them a way to answer without calling back.

```
[Agency Name]: Sorry we missed your call. [Agent Name] here. Calling about a truck insurance quote? Reply here or call [Your Number]. Reply STOP to opt out.
```

When they reply "yes" or with a truck count, treat it exactly like a quote request: the first email goes out, and the 7-day sequence starts at Day 0.

The first email (same five minutes)

The email backs up the text. It confirms the request landed, says what happens next, and asks the four questions a licensed agent needs before any carrier will look at the risk. Keep it plain text — no banner, no PDF. Truckers read it on a phone.

Subject: Your truck insurance quote — 4 quick questions

```
Hi [First Name],

This is [Agent Name], a licensed agent at [Agency Name]. We got your quote request
and I've started your file.

Here's what happens next: I match your operation to the carriers that write it,
send you a quote, and go over it with you on a 10-minute call. To get that moving,
reply to this email (or text me at [Your Number]) with:

1. Is your authority new (first year) or established? Your DOT or MC number if you
have it.
2. How many power units, and what do you haul (dry van, reefer, flatbed, hotshot,
auto hauler, other)?
3. Who is your current carrier, if any?
4. Your renewal date, and how far you run (local, regional, long haul).

If you're on the road, a text is fine. I'll have questions answered the same day.

[Agent Name]
[Agency Name] | [Your Number]
```

If the lead already told you the truck count in the text, drop that question and ask the next one. Every question you don't need to ask twice is a reason for them to answer.

7-day sequence A: they asked for a quote but never answered

Six touches in seven days, text and call first, email as the long-form backup. Stop the sequence the moment they reply, book, or opt out. Send texts between 9 a.m. and 8 p.m. in the trucker's time zone.

DAY	CHANNEL	MESSAGE OR TALK TRACK	GOAL
0 **first 5 min**	Text + email	First text (any version above) and the first email.	Open the conversation; get one answer.
0 **+20 min, no reply**	Text	`[Agency Name]: [First Name], still here when you're ready. Reply with your truck count and I'll get a licensed agent on your quote today. Reply STOP to opt out.`	Catch them at the next stop.
1 **morning**	Call, then voicemail	"Hi [First Name], [Agent Name] with [Agency Name] about the truck insurance quote you requested. I need two things to get it started. Call or text me at [Your Number]. Again, [Your Number]."	Live contact. Say the number twice.
2	Text	`[First Name], quick one from [Agent Name] at [Agency Name]: is your authority new or established? That decides which carriers I can go to first.`	A one-word answer starts the file.
3	Call, then text	Call first. No answer: `[Agent Name] at [Agency Name]: tried you by phone. If a text is easier, send your DOT # and truck count and I'll quote from that. Reply STOP to opt out.`	Lower the effort to reply.
5	Email	Subject: "What I need to quote your truck" — three lines: the four questions again, the documents that speed a quote (DOT/MC, VIN list, current dec page if any), and your number.	Give them the whole list once.
7	Text	`[Agent Name] at [Agency Name]: last check from me. If the timing's off, send your renewal month and I'll reach out 90 days before. Reply STOP to opt out.`	Close the loop or capture the renewal date.

If Day 7 gets a renewal month, write it on the file and move the lead to the renewal calendar (see "After day 7"). If it gets nothing, mark the lead cold and stop.

7-day sequence B: you sent a quote and they went quiet

A quiet lead after a quote usually means one of three things: the email never got read, another agent came in with a number, or something in the process (filings, down payment, paperwork) stalled them. Each touch tests one of those.

DAY	CHANNEL	MESSAGE OR TALK TRACK	GOAL
0 quote goes out	Text	`[Agency Name]: [First Name], your quote just went out by email from [Agent Name]. Reply here if it didn't come through or you want me to walk you through it.`	Make sure the quote was seen.
1	Text	`[First Name], did the quote from [Agent Name] at [Agency Name] come through OK? Any part you want me to go over?`	Surface questions early.
2	Call, then voicemail	"Hi [First Name], [Agent Name] at [Agency Name]. I sent your quote yesterday and wanted to walk through it — takes ten minutes. Call or text me at [Your Number]. That's [Your Number]."	Get the quote conversation live.
3	Text	`[Agent Name] at [Agency Name]: tried calling about the quote. If another agent came in lower, tell me what they quoted and I'll check it's apples to apples.`	Draw out the competing quote.
5	Text	`[First Name], quick check from [Agent Name], [Agency Name]: anything holding the quote up? Filings, down payment, or timing? Reply one word and I'll handle it.`	Find the process blocker.
7	Text + email	Text: `[Agent Name] at [Agency Name]: last note on the quote. It holds until [Date]. Bound elsewhere? Reply DONE and I'll close the file. Reply STOP to opt out.` Email the same day: subject "Your quote holds until [Date]" — the quote attached again, what changes at bind (down payment, filings, certificates), your number.	A clean yes, no, or date.

"Apples to apples" matters in trucking: limits, radius, cargo, and filings differ between quotes more often than price does. Day 3 is where you find out whether the lower number is the same policy.

After day 7

Mark it cold, don't delete it. A lead that gave you nothing in seven days goes to "cold" with the date and whatever you learned (truck count, authority status, renewal month). Cold is a status, not a verdict: that operator still needs insurance next year.

Quarterly check-in. Once a quarter, one text to every cold lead that never opted out:

> `[Agent Name] at [Agency Name]: checking in. Still running [truck count] trucks? If your renewal's coming up, I can take a fresh look. Reply STOP to opt out.`

Send it in small batches so replies get answered the same day, and stop the batch if opt-outs climb.

The renewal window. Any lead or quoted prospect with a known renewal date gets three dated touches: 90 days out (text: "your policy renews around [Date] — want me to shop it so there's time to move if it makes sense?"), 60 days out (call, plus the documents you need), and 30 days out (text: "30 days out. If you haven't heard from your current agent, that's your answer."). Agents and brokers now start renewals 90 to 150 days ahead because late renewals get priced as risky; a trucker who waits until 30 days out is choosing between whatever is left. [11][12] Your 90-day text is the one most agencies never send.

Re-contact triggers. A cold lead who fills out your form again, calls, or replies to a check-in goes straight back to Day 0 of sequence A, with one line added to the first text: "Good to see you back."

Texting rules for agencies (practical, not legal advice)

Consent. Under the TCPA, a text counts as a call. A trucker who gives you their mobile number on a quote form has given permission to be contacted about that quote, which covers the texts in this playbook. Marketing texts — offers, promotions, anything not about the request — need prior express written consent: a clear disclosure on the form, a separate box they tick, and a line that consent is not a condition of purchase. [16][17] Put the checkbox on your form now so the renewal campaign later is covered.

Identify yourself and let them out. The CTIA messaging principles, which carriers enforce, want the sender named in the message and standard STOP wording honored (stop, end, unsubscribe, cancel, quit), with one confirmation after an opt-out and nothing after that. [18] That is why every first text in this playbook starts with the agency name and ends with "Reply STOP to opt out."

Hours. Federal rules bar telephone solicitations before 8 a.m. or after 9 p.m. in the recipient's local time, and several states are tighter: Florida and Oklahoma end at 8 p.m., and Texas allows 9 a.m. to 9 p.m. Monday through Saturday and noon to 9 p.m. on Sunday. Whether texts the trucker asked for count as solicitations is still being argued; the safe habit is 9 a.m. to 8 p.m. where the trucker is, every day. [19][20][21]

Register your number. Business texts from a regular 10-digit number must be registered for A2P 10DLC through your texting platform: a brand (your agency) and a campaign (what you send). Carriers block unregistered traffic, so a new agency number that "doesn't deliver" is usually an unregistered one. [22]

Keep it one-to-one. These are conversations with people who asked for a quote. No blasting purchased lists, no texting a lead who said stop, and no "rates from $" claims in any message — a quote comes from an agent, not a text.

One-page checklist

Setup (once)

- [ ] One texting number for the agency, registered for A2P 10DLC, used for every text
- [ ] Quote form asks for mobile number and has a separate, unchecked marketing-consent box
- [ ] Templates saved in your phone or CRM with [Agency Name], [Agent Name], [Your Number] filled in
- [ ] Missed-call text-back turned on (or a rule: every missed call gets the text within a minute)
- [ ] A place to log each lead: date, source, authority status, trucks, carrier, renewal date, status

Every new quote request

- [ ] First text within 5 minutes (agency name first, one question, STOP line)
- [ ] First email within 5 minutes (confirm, what happens next, 4 questions)
- [ ] No reply in 20 minutes: second text
- [ ] Day 1 call + voicemail with the number said twice
- [ ] Day 2 text (authority question) · Day 3 call + text · Day 5 email · Day 7 last text
- [ ] Stop the sequence the moment they reply, book, or say STOP

Every quote sent

- [ ] Day 0 "your quote went out" text · Day 1 check text · Day 2 call · Day 3 apples-to-apples text · Day 5 blocker text · Day 7 "holds until [Date]" text + email
- [ ] Competing quote? Compare limits, radius, cargo and filings before price

After day 7

- [ ] Mark cold with the date and what you learned; never delete
- [ ] Renewal date known? Schedule the 90 / 60 / 30-day touches now
- [ ] Quarterly check-in text to cold leads, in small batches

Rules that never bend

- [ ] Texts only 9 a.m.–8 p.m. where the trucker is
- [ ] Agency name in the first text; STOP honored instantly, one confirmation, then silence
- [ ] No rates, "cheapest," coverage or approval promises in any text or email

The hard part is not the templates. It is sending touch five on a Tuesday for a lead that came in last Thursday, for every lead, every week. If that is the part that keeps slipping, that is the part to automate.

Free 20-minute Quote Leak Review

Want to see where your quote requests are leaking right now: speed, follow-up, quotes that went quiet, renewals nobody called? Reply to the email this playbook came in, and we'll set up a free 20-minute Quote Leak Review on Google Meet. We look at your actual lead flow and you leave with the three fixes that matter most, whether or not you ever hire us.

Global TLM (Global Trucking Lead Machine) builds the system that runs this playbook for trucking insurance agencies: Meta ads that bring in quote requests, GoHighLevel automation that sends every touch on time, and a texting assistant that qualifies and books the call while your agents are quoting. Results vary by market, budget and offer.

The Global TLM team
globaltlm.com

Sources

Every number in this playbook comes from one of these. Where a source is a vendor's own data, it says so.

1. Oldroyd, McElheran & Elkington, "The Short Life of Online Sales Leads," Harvard Business Review, March 2011 — hbr.org/2011/03/the-short-life-of-online-sales-leads (audit of 2,241 companies; 1.25M leads at 42 companies). Figures confirmed from pages quoting the article; one author ran a lead-response software company.
2. Elkington & Oldroyd, "Lead Response Management Study," InsideSales.com/MIT, 2007 — mortech.com/…/mit_study.pdf (six companies; the origin of the "5 minutes" claims; vendor data, not used for numbers here).
3. Leads360/Velocify, "The Ultimate Contact Strategy," 2012 — slideshare.net/Velocify/the-ultimate-contact-strategy (origin of "391%"; undefined baseline, not used for numbers here).
4. Leads360 insurance lead study, Claims Journal, Nov 2009 — claimsjournal.com/services/newswire/2009/11/18/105398.htm (second attempt +87%; 93% reached by the sixth attempt). Vendor data.
5. Leads360 texting analysis, MarketingProfs, 2013 — marketingprofs.com/charts/2013/10210 (text after contact lifts conversion; text before contact lowers reach). Vendor data.
6. EZ Texting, 2025 Consumer Texting Behavior Report (1,074 US mobile users, Nov 2024) — eztexting.com/press/…/2025-consumer-texting-behavior-report (57% expect a reply within 15 minutes). Vendor survey.
7. Wingfield, "How to save on commercial truck insurance in 2025," FreightWaves, May 2025 — freightwaves.com/news/how-to-save-on-commercial-truck-insurance-in-2025… (multiple quotes and timing; anecdotal).
8. FMCSA, Insurance Filing Requirements — fmcsa.dot.gov/registration/insurance-filing-requirements ($750,000 minimum; authority not granted until filings are in effect).
9. FreightWaves, "New venture trucking insurance," Feb 2018 — freightwaves.com/?p=41550 (fewer markets and higher premiums for new ventures).
10. FreightWaves, Aug 2020 — freightwaves.com/?p=287876; and Overdrive, "State of insurance for independents with new authority," 2017 — equipmentworld.com/…/state-of-insurance-for-independents-with-new-authority (first-year rates, improvement with clean experience).
11. Wingfield, FreightWaves, May 2025 (as in 7) — start renewal quoting 90–120 days out; review terms 30 days before.

12. Insurance Business, "The 30-day renewal is dead," Sep 2026 — insurancebusinessmag.com/…/the-30day-renewal-is-dead (brokers starting 120–150 days out).
13. 49 CFR 392.80, texting prohibition — law.cornell.edu/cfr/text/49/392.80
14. FMCSA, Mobile Phone Rule fact sheet — fmcsa.dot.gov/…/Mobile_Phone_Rule_Fact_Sheet.pdf
15. FMCSA, Summary of Hours-of-Service Regulations — fmcsa.dot.gov/regulations/hours-service/summary-hours-service-regulations
16. 47 CFR 64.1200 (TCPA rules: consent, written consent, texts as calls) — ecfr.gov/current/title-47/…/section-64.1200
17. Squire Patton Boggs, "Recent TCPA rulings explain prior express consent," 2014 — squirepattonboggs.com/…/recent-tcpa-rulings-explain-prior-express-consent
18. CTIA, Messaging Principles and Best Practices, May 2023 — assets.ecourtdate.com/files/ctia-best-practices.pdf (sender identification, STOP handling, consent tiers).
19. 47 CFR 64.1200(c)(1) and (e) (8 a.m.–9 p.m. local time) — as in 16; FCC Consumer and Governmental Affairs Bureau request for comment on quiet hours and consented texts, DA 25-216, March 2025 — infobytes.orrick.com/…/CONSUMER-AND-GOVERNMENTAL-AFFAIRS-BUREAU-SEEKS-COMMENT.pdf
20. Goodwin, "Mini-TCPA laws you should know," Feb 2023 — goodwinlaw.com/…/mini-tcpa-laws-you-should-know (Florida and Oklahoma 8 a.m.–8 p.m.)
21. Texas Business & Commerce Code § 301.051 — texas.public.law/statutes/tex._bus._&_com._code_section_301.051
22. Twilio, A2P 10DLC overview — twilio.com/docs/conversations/a2p-10dlc-conversations; and "Shutdown of unregistered 10DLC messaging" — support.twilio.com/hc/en-us/articles/14910496447771

Not used on purpose, because the sourcing is weak or missing: "98% SMS open rate," "90% of texts read in 3 minutes," "it takes 8 touches," and any count of how many quotes an owner-operator gets.